

Michelle Vasquez — Portfolio Working Document

A working document for gathering your portfolio ideas. Fill in the bracketed prompts. When you're ready to publish, move your content to a platform of your choice — a website (Webflow, Framer, Notion, Squarespace, GitHub Pages), the downloadable HTML template if you want to hand-code it, or just export this document to PDF.

Tip: open this in Google Docs (File → Open → Upload) for easy peer-feedback sharing on 6/3.

Commented [MV1]: I used this document to write out instructions, introductions, and fill in the blocks for each of the case studies I am using (I have only included 3 projects we completed in class and I Design & Education project that follow the instructions you've laid out below because this was the first time I produced or explained the finished result, other ENGS projects only included ideation and observation steps.)

Cover

- **Your name:** Michelle Vasquez
- **Tagline — one sentence for an outsider:** I map systems, find where they fail people, and design the service layer that fixes it.
- **Role · Location:** Cultural Anthropology Major and Human Centered Design Minor based in Hanover, NH
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Hero Hook

The opening line visitors see first. Tell them what you do in five seconds. Take a cue from Gloria Lo's "*I design, sing, paint & write.*"

Your hook: I observe, write, and design.

About Me

A short, human introduction — *not* a résumé. 1–3 paragraphs.

Paragraph 1 — Who you are and what kinds of problems pull you in. Be specific. "Designing for people who cook on a budget" lands better than "user-centered design."

I am drawn to designing and reworking systems and services, especially in the educational field. Efforts to reform American education stretch back 150 years, with mixed results. This history makes it easy to assume that the system is broken beyond fixing, or that only top-down legislation can move it. I believe meaningful change comes from the people closest to students: educators, parents, administrators, and the designers who work alongside them. That last group is where I want to contribute.

Paragraph 2 — How you work. Methods, collaborators, the kind of team you do your best work with.

My projects are based on the Human Centered Design principles and values, designing for real human needs rather than adapting humans to machines. The process I follow draws on IDEO's popular framework: empathize, define, ideate, prototype, and test. In practice, that means I spend more time than most in the first two phases. I've found that the quality of everything toward the latter end, the ideas, the prototypes, the final design, depends almost entirely on how well you've understood the problem and the people facing it before you try to solve it. Support following these steps has been made easy by the project-based courses offered by the HCD minor here at Dartmouth. I have worked with small groups of 3-4 other HCD students, as well as, collaborated with local Upper Valley schools and organizations.

Paragraph 3 — Who you are when you're not designing. One or two real, specific things. Personality belongs here.

Outside of design, I spend a lot of time writing. This is mainly in the form of journaling about the things I thought and saw that day or writing short stories based on the observations I've made throughout the day. The way I often understand and begin to process big emotions and events is to first write about them. That instinct to observe and sit with something before drawing conclusions has shaped how I design -- I'm rarely the first person in the room to propose a solution, but I tend to ask the question nobody thought to write down.

Case Studies — Pick 3 to 5

The 6-block structure below is what strong UX case studies have in common. Each block should be readable in 30 seconds; depth lives in the figures and captions.

Duplicate the structure below for each case study.

Case Study 01 — Belonging from the Start: Designing a Framework for Welcoming Multilingual Students in the Hartford School District

Concept tags: Invisible systems made visible; interviewing users; dual desires, experience economy; emotional design; service (SEMINAL)

One-sentence outcome: Created a foundation of research, observations, and interview data for a team of HCD students, Hartford School District partners, and Professor Rafe Steinhauer to continue working on reshaping the onboarding process for English language Learners in the school district.

Project Meta

- **My role:** Project Manager; Co-designer
- **Team:** Project manager, 5 total students (including PM), 3 Hartford School District partners
- **Timeline:** Oct-Nov 2025
- **Tools:** Miro, Canva, Google Slides

1. Context

Set the scene in 2–4 sentences. What is the product or organization? What was happening when you joined? Why was this problem on someone’s radar?

This was a collaborative project that brought together Rafe’s Design & Education course, with Upper Valley School Districts. We were separate into small groups and paired with the Hartford School District, who had already created a team of Equity Coordinators and Administrators to tackle issues that they had identified in that realm in the middle and high schools.

2. The Problem

Frame the problem in plain, empathetic language. *Not:* “we needed to optimize the onboarding funnel.” *Instead:* “first-time users were dropping off before they ever saw the product work.” If you have a user quote or a statistic, lead with it.

Our challenge is to understand the ELL student experience and develop a plan for how to provide them an immediate sense of belonging in their first few months in the Hartford School District.

3. Research

What did you do to understand the problem? Interviews, surveys, analytics, competitive teardown, journey maps. Name the methods, but lead with the insight that emerged. Include figures: sticky-note synthesis, journey map, interview themes.

For this project, my team and I conducted student and stakeholder interviews (11 students across middle school and high school, 11 additional stakeholder – including principals, social workers, teachers, and ELL educators). We led two co-creation sessions with stakeholders with gallery walks and affinity mapping and created a flowchart that traced an ELL students’ journey from enrollment in an HSD school through graduation. The central insight that emerged was that belonging for ELL (English Language Learning) students is less about language mastery and more about connection. Through sports, peer relationships, and cultural expression, ELL students were able to find a sense of belonging that extended beyond academics. Students described feeling exhausted by constant English immersion, isolated without peers that spoke their native-language, and disconnected from their culture, while educators felt underprepared and defaulted to

deferring all ELL responsibility to one of the only two ML (Multi-Lingual) teachers in the district.

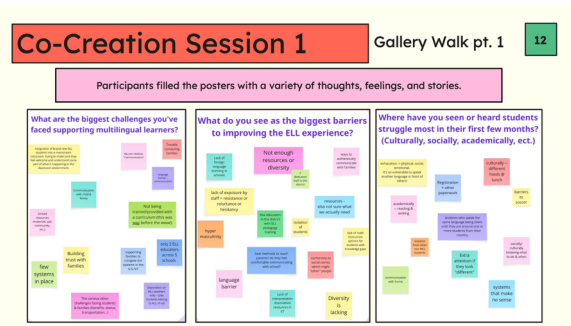


Figure 1: A sample of notes collected during a gallery walk exercise at our first co-creation session with stakeholders.

4. Process

Walk through how you went from research to design. Wireframes, IA, prototypes, what you tried and rejected. *Mention at least one dead end and what it taught you.* Process is the proof you can do the work.

Much of this project involved data collecting and organizing of themes that emerged through affinity mapping and flowchart exercises. From these, our team was able to identify orientation as a key intervention point, which directly shaped the three napkin pitches we created for continued building by a new HSD team. Along the way, we encountered a few dead ends that mostly related to methods educators employed to try to connect with students that did not work, like the initial idea of relying on digital translation tools and apps like Talking points and Parent Square. From there, we learned that new apps or technology was not the barrier to belonging and a shift toward human-centered interventions like mentorship programs and community building events would be more efficient.

Secondary Research Connections to Insights

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Power of sports (bonding activities without language) • Youth sports help students build confidence • Sports increase self-esteem and creativity • Teaches based language learning is more beneficial to students • Sports provide an environment for students to engage with peers outside of the classroom environment	People who don't learn foreign languages don't understand the difficulty and discomfort of trying to speak • The term "Language Learning Anxiety" causes more "academic, cognitive, and social fears" • Students can spend their days at school in a constant state of worry over assessments, communication anxiety, and the unknown	ELL students need a way to feel belonging while maintaining their native language/ culture • HL students can provide valuable cultural learning experiences to non-ELL students • Formal schooling influences student ideologies and impacts their peer interactions. • Multicultural students can often feel confused or like they've lost a part of themselves
Students (and Parents) need access to translated materials • Hard to translate websites/ online information are a barrier to parent involvement • Breaking the communication barrier between parents and teachers is most effectively done when teachers have immediate translating tools and they have been trained to use them	Existing systems are difficult to navigate for Non-English speakers • After arrival in the US, 30% of immigrant families live below the poverty line meaning that external factors already put pressure on the ELL students • Intentional or unintentional barriers in the environment or administrative processes for school enrollment can have negative impacts on students	Teacher effort matters more than fluency • Culturally responsive teaching and social-emotional learning integration are essential as teachers should validate diverse cultural backgrounds to help ELL students develop empathy, resilience, and a sense of community

Figure 2: Chart of common challenges and comments we received after our interviews with ELL students and stakeholders.

5. Key Decisions

Pick the 2–3 design decisions that mattered most. For each: what you chose, what you considered, why this option won. Tie every decision back to the problem in block 2.

One design decision we made was choosing to center on extracurriculars and cultural expression as areas to develop a sense of belonging rather than academic supports. Initially, as we learned that ELL students typically score lower than English-speaking peers, we thought of ways to build belonging in the classroom and make students feel more comfortable learning. As we expanded our research with more interviews and discussions with stakeholders, we saw how extracurricular activities bridge the connection between ELL students and their school communities when they first arrive in HSD.

To go along with this, another design decision we made was choosing to do a persona map before creating our napkin pitches. This persona map helped us identify which ELL to design for. We mapped school engagement and access to a first-language community outside of school. Students who fell in the lower-left quadrant – those with low extracurricular engagement and low native-language community – face the most isolation and struggle for belonging. One High School student at Hartford High stated that she felt exhausted by constant English immersion and distant from her culture after being unable to communicate to anyone in her native language or about her culture outside of the home. Designing from the hardest cases, like this one, shifting our ideas toward ones that would create a meaningful impact for the students that struggle the most and help all future incoming ELL students find their place in HSD.

3. Peer Mentor Program

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Description

A volunteer-based program that recruits upperclassmen HSD students, community members, or Dartmouth students to “mentor” incoming ELL students of the same cultural background or who speak the same language.

Students get paired with their mentor. If the mentor is school-specific, mentor/mentees can eat lunch together on the first day, get shown around school, explore new extracurriculars, etc.

For out-of-school mentors, mentors can help transport mentees to sports practices, help with homework, get coffee together, attend shows/games, or simply be someone to talk to about their shared culture/language.

Figure 3: Napkin Pitch and description for a peer mentor program that pairs ELL students, with Dartmouth students who speak the same language.

6. Outcome & Reflection

- **What changed:** This project produced three beginning stages of program design: a sports tryout program, a Multicultural Night event, and a peer mentorship program partnered with Dartmouth College. The bulk of this project, and the most significant, was the collection of data from ELL students, administrators, district members, educators, and both ML teachers (as well as other stakeholders). These are the foundation of knowledge that our partners in HSD and the student team working with Rafe Steinhauer will build up from.
- **What you learned:** The hardest design constraint wasn't generating ideas; it was resisting the impulse to want to solve administrative or language barrier issues (which are real but outside of our scope) and focus on the issue of belonging that the most isolated students faced. In future iterations, building a pilot for even just one program idea before the project ended, could have left the new team with one set of user tested data to build from as they continued the project.

Case Study 02 — 30 Years Redesign Challenge (The Modular Sneaker)

Concept Tags: emotionally durable design, repair as understanding, longevity (SEMINAL), service, craftsmanship, constraint as identity

One-sentence outcome: We redesigned the sneaker as a modular, part-swappable product so consumer may only replace what wears out or falls out of style – addressing the core insight that people tend to discard shoes not because the whole shoe fails, but because one part does.

Project Meta

- **My role:** Co-Designer; Co-Presenter; Main Service Designer
- **Team:** 2 HCD students in Design Survivor course (ENGS 15.15)
- **Timeline:** April 2026 (1 week)
- **Tools:** Gemini; Fuser; Google Slides

1. Context

Set the scene in 2–4 sentences. What is the product or organization? What was happening when you joined? Why was this problem on someone's radar?

This project was a design challenge in a Human-Centered Design course (ENGS 15.15) built around the question: what would it take to design a product that someone could own and use for 30 years? My partner and I chose to focus on the sneaker industry because, even though shoes are considered a necessity, 2.68 billion pairs of sneakers are purchased annually in the United States alone, most lasting only

12-18 months before being thrown out. The expense and sustainability concerns are what got us interested and provoked this design.

2. The Problem

Frame the problem in plain, empathetic language. *Not:* “we needed to optimize the onboarding funnel.” *Instead:* “first-time users were dropping off before they ever saw the product work.” If you have a user quote or a statistic, lead with it.

People are not discarding sneakers because the whole shoe fails, rather they are getting rid of them because one part wears out or the shoe falls out of style or no longer fits their personal needs. The average sneaker does not offer a way to fix just one part. The current sneaker shopping experience offers just one choice: pick a shoe and live with it.

3. Research

What did you do to understand the problem? Interviews, surveys, analytics, competitive teardown, journey maps. Name the methods, but lead with the insight that emerged. Include figures: sticky-note synthesis, journey map, interview themes.

My partner and I started by conducting individual interviews with people who had owned object for 30 or more years, looking for patterns across these cases. Three themes emerged: emotional attachments between people and the objects that help identity and memory, durability in items that still work and feel wasteful to throw away, and the future utility of certain items where people delay disposing products because they believe they will need it again in future.



Figure 1: Pattern synthesis from specific examples from interviews.

4. Process

Walk through how you went from research to design. Wireframes, IA, prototypes, what you tried and rejected. *Mention at least one dead end and what it taught you.* Process is the proof you can do the work.

From the three patterns that emerged, our team decided to focus on how our sneaker redesign could best create user agency over the object continuously over time. Following Chapman's Emotionally Durable Design, Sennett's theory of repair as understanding, and Patagonia's durability-as-desirability model, the modular sneaker puts the consumer in the role of a craftsman from the start: building their shoe, replacing parts when needed or desired, and the ability to trade pieces in for store credit when done.

In our ideation stage, we considered a change of experience by designing a simple repair-service for broken or worn shoes. We ultimately decided to scrap this idea as it aims more on fixing the problem when we want more to avoid the issue all together.

<u>Principle Transfer Statement</u>		
Chapman — Emotionally Durable Design	Sennett — The Craftsman	Patagonia — Durability Is The Desirability
The principle we transferred from Chapman's theory of emotionally durable design is that objects should grow and evolve with the owner over time. We applied this as a sneaker redesign that uses modular technology, so consumers may exchange parts only when they degrade or purchase new designs of upgraded parts instead of purchasing a whole new pair of sneakers. We understand that consumers like and dislikes change over time, with this redesign our sneakers can change with them	The principle we transferred from Sennett's theory of repairs is a form of understanding applied as a fully customizable product that allows consumers to construct their own ideal shoe. This positions the consumer as their own shoe craftsman. They are in control and may add whichever aspects of the design that suit their needs and desires, and replace them once they don't.	The principle we transferred from Patagonia's case study on the desirability of an object's durability, applied as the modular and interchangeable aspects of a modular sneaker. As trends evolve and sneakers wear down with usage, a consumer may simply order new uppers, insoles, outsoles, etc. Consumers are not required to spend hundreds of dollars replacing shoes simply because they fell out style or one piece fails. aka → Reduce high recurring costs

Figure 2: Principal transfer slide that maps Chapman, Sennett, and Patagonia's theories to a specific design feature.

5. Key Decisions

Pick the 2–3 design decisions that mattered most. For each: what you chose, what you considered, why this option won. Tie every decision back to the problem in block 2.

Rather than just selling replacement parts, our design includes a mail-in or in-store trade system where used parts can be recycled in exchange for store credit. This addressed the sustainability problem directly and created a business incentive for durability over disposal.

The redesigned retail experience replaces the cold, warehouse format with a workshop-style space where customers build their shoe out of parts that suit them and

their specific style and needs. This was chosen because the existing store format, with walls of near identical choices, actively discourages the relationship-building with an object that makes long-term ownership possible and attractive to users.

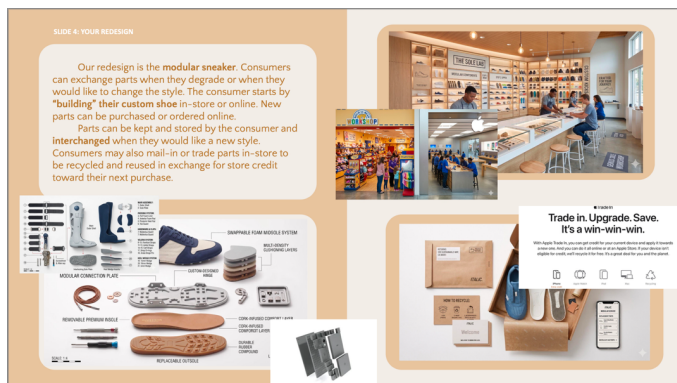


Figure 3: Modular sneaker design, mail-in/trade-in system, and store design and experience remodel.

6. Outcome & Reflection

- **What changed:** While no prototype was built or tested, this concept design reframes the sneaker's entire lifecycle – from a easily disposable product that changes with growing trends to an evolving, owner-managed product.
- **What you learned:** Through this process, I was able to learn the value of real people's stories. Before even coming up with our design focus, my partner and I heard real accounts of why people chose to own products for such a long period of time. This made every design decision feel grounded and informed the feeling we wanted to evoke with our final product.

Case Study 03 — Dartmouth Innovative Project Studio (DIPS)

Concept Tags: technology as a teammate, useful friction, candor without authority, curation as self-knowledge, body of work, invisible systems made visible, service design under pressure

One-sentence outcome: {{e.g., “Cut appointment no-shows by 41% by redesigning the reminder system to speak the patient’s first language.”}}

Project Meta

- **My role:** Lead Designer

- **Team:** Solo
- **Timeline:** May-June 2026 (3 weeks)
- **Tools:** Claude Codel; Canva
- **Live link:** <https://dartmouthinnovativeprojectstudio.netlify.app/>

1. Context

Set the scene in 2–4 sentences. What is the product or organization? What was happening when you joined? Why was this problem on someone’s radar?

The Dartmouth Innovative Project Studio was a final project built for ENGS 15.15 (Design Survivor). The idea came from looking at a folder on a desktop full of projects from this class and others that I had simply forgotten about. At Dartmouth, a common belief amongst students is that portfolios and independent projects only exist to serve future purposes — job applications, grad school applications, professional networking, etc. That culture means creative work goes undocumented if it isn’t impressive or professional enough, and students who aren’t in STEM, Art, or Business fields often regard their project work as less valuable.

2. The Problem

Frame the problem in plain, empathetic language. *Not:* “we needed to optimize the onboarding funnel.” *Instead:* “first-time users were dropping off before they ever saw the product work.” If you have a user quote or a statistic, lead with it.

Students spend days, sometimes even weeks, working on projects that had nowhere to live after the class ended. The feedback on this work is often external from professors or hiring committees, which ultimately make the work feel disposable. Independent projects and class assignments are constantly devalued. The core belief behind DIPS: exhibiting work changes how students value it in the first place. The goal was to create a space where every project has a purpose, is seen, and can live for future students to reference and gain inspiration from.

3. Research

What did you do to understand the problem? Interviews, surveys, analytics, competitive teardown, journey maps. Name the methods, but lead with the insight that emerged. Include figures: sticky-note synthesis, journey map, interview themes.

Research began with a short round of interviews with Dartmouth students, conducted at during Version 1 and revisited while building Version 3 for final user testing stages. Interviews allow me to hear what features would make the site useful and what would help users and make the website easy and effective.

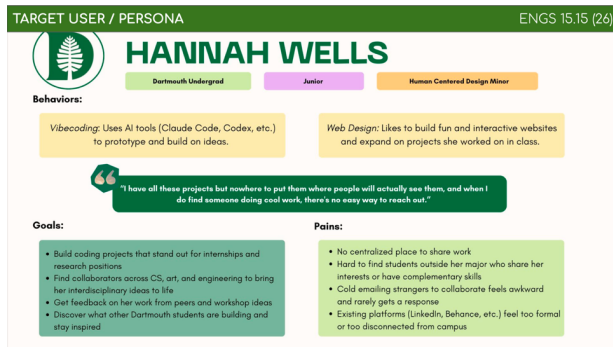


Figure 1: Persona of a target user; their goals and challenges when it comes to displaying project work.

4. Process

Walk through how you went from research to design. Wireframes, IA, prototypes, what you tried and rejected. *Mention at least one dead end and what it taught you.* Process is the proof you can do the work.

The project progressed from paper and pencil sketches to Canva drafts to a vibecoded web app using Claude Code. My first draft on Canva was too busy and pastel, there was no room for navigation or a search feature, and no directions for how to use the site. The second version fixed the visual problem but introduced a new one: prompts to Claude Code were too vague, so Claude started creating its own iteration of the design, generating its own art instead of sourcing it and using colors and fonts that simply weren't wanted.

The dead end here was trying to solve design and function at the same time. The fix was to set the overall design difficulties aside and work on what interactive features would be most successful first, the sidebar, navigation, upload procedure, and then go back to the aesthetics of the final site.

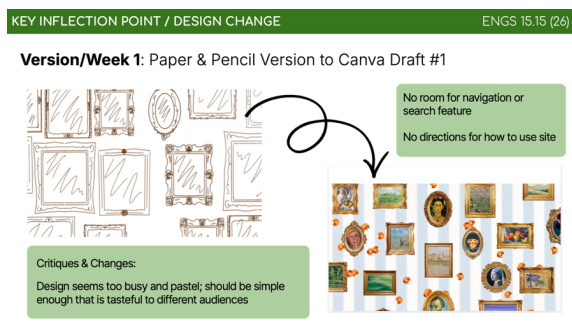


Figure 2: Shift from version 1 of the design to a draft for version 2.

5. Key Decisions

Pick the 2–3 design decisions that mattered most. For each: what you chose, what you considered, why this option won. Tie every decision back to the problem in block 2.

Dialing back on the design rather than adding to it was one significant design choice that I made while working on this project. The original Canva design was full of color and patterns. It had personality but I couldn't imagine students actually using it or having it be a part of the Dartmouth experience. The difficult decision was to take a hard look at what had been designed and strip many of the elements that were originally thought to give the site personality but really just made the page look busy. Switching to Dartmouth's green wasn't just an aesthetic choice it immediately communicated who the site was built for.

To go along with this, I made the decision to let the design take a backseat and work on what interactive features would be most successful. When Claude kept going in its own direction visually, the instinct was to keep fighting it on aesthetics. User tests confirmed what mattered: the ability to write in filters so users could get specific with what they were looking for, and a message system so the site could facilitate actual collaboration, not just browsing. Getting function right first made finishing the design feel achievable rather than like starting over.

KEY INFLECTION POINT / DESIGN CHANGE

ENGS 15.15 (26)

Version/Week 3: Finalized Claude Code App and Features



Figure 3: Final version of DIPS presented at the end of this course with final user feedback implementation.

6. Outcome & Reflection

- **What changed:** A functioning, Claude Code-built web app reached V3 and was presented at Technigala. While this site is nowhere near ready to be published for all users, it was an idea born from a forgotten folder on a desktop became a real, shareable platform that other Dartmouth students could eventually be able to engage with. There is no usage metric yet, I am hopeful I can continue to collaborate with Dartmouth and build on and implement this website for students.
- **What you learned:** "Good design is unfinished." This is a principle of "good design" that I developed, and DIPS proved that to be true. I started this course thinking good design required time, experience, exhaustive research, and certainty, and I leave it knowing that what it more importantly requires is a willingness to start, a discipline to listen and iterate, and the humility to let things that aren't working go.

SEMINAL Systems Map

Across your 10 weeks (and other portfolio-able work), which SEMINAL systems did you gravitate toward? Which did you avoid? Note specifics under each letter.

- **S — Service** (experience journeys, touchpoints, delivery): I mostly gravitated toward service design throughout my 10 weeks in the Design Survivor course. I continuously made an effort to chart user interactions and challenges and kept those in mind as I was ideating and designing. I am passionate about service design because it keeps people visible throughout the process as it's harder to lose sight of the human when you're literally charting their experience.
- **E — Energy** (environmental flows, carbon, power): While I did make a continuous effort to analyze how sustainable materials and systems could play a role in my designs (especially in the 30 years Challenge), I did not engage much with this tag otherwise as the technical features were not considered in many of my designs as much as the potential benefits it could have for users.
- **M — Material** (physical matter, form, manufacturing): Material was a part of my designs as it is a hard category to stay away from, especially as you are designing products. As I was working on the 30 Years project with the modular show, my teammate and I discussed at length what materials we would be using and weighed the pros and cons of various types as we chose.
- **I — Interaction / Sensory** (how designs are experienced, perceived, used): The majority, if not all, of my designs fit in this tag. As with service design, I am the most passionate and thoughtful about how people will interact with the designs I create and what that experience will look like for different users with different needs and desires.
- **N — Natural** (ecology, organisms, food systems): Given that I don't have much experience with natural design, this was a tag that I did not engage with much.
- **A — Artificial** (computation, AI, machine intelligence): I used AI, specifically Claude Code, to vibecode my final project for this course. I worked back and forth with AI to

get my ideas across and make sure the web app was functioning as smooth as possible.

- **L — Longevity** (durability, repair, aging, aesthetics): Longevity was a tag that I didn't think I would engage with much at first, but as the weeks went on I realized that design should be durable. Not only for sustainability purposes, but designs with longer lives have a greater chance of being reshaped and given new meaning with each user. Longevity is what creates an iconic product.

What does the pattern reveal?

Looking at the patterns that emerge across my projects and the SEMINAL systems, I clearly gravitate toward Service and Sensory/Interaction as my main categories for design. AI (Artificial) became a tool I used to implement these values rather than a main subject and the Longevity of designed products and service became a focus because of the relationships users build with items over time. I avoided the Natural and Energy tags, not an oversight on my part but more of an honest reflection of where my skills and passions truly live when it comes to designing. The pattern reveals me as a designer who is most confident and most generative when the question is "how will a real person experience this?" and "how do I make sure that experience lasts?"

POV Statement (500–750 words)

Your point of view as a designer, in words. *Not a style* — values, instincts, patterns. Show evolution from your Week 6 midterm POV to now.

In my midterm reflection I wrote that "good design is unfinished." Looking back on the work we've done this term and the website I created; I believe it more than ever. However, what I meant then was that designs can always be improved, that nothing is truly finished. What I know now is different, that unfinished isn't a flaw in good design, it's the point. A design with a longer life has more chances to be reshaped and given new meaning by the people who use it. At the midterm I was still thinking about completion, drowning in stress over completing the final deliverable and not looking at the future of my design.

This essentially sums up how I, and my approach to design, has changed over these past few weeks. For this final challenge I was forced to engage with things I had never done before. Yet, as I have seen throughout this class, my confidence in designing has grown considerably because of this. This course has pushed me to run through the design process, from ideation to creation, without giving me the time to second guess myself or stray from my first few original ideas. This has given me the confidence to run with the first idea that strikes my interest and aligns with my passions, and I think this has allowed me to create better projects overall. I don't think this project, or I, am finished. Even now that the course is over, I can already see where Version 4 would begin. But, as I before, I believe "good design is unfinished," and DIPS has proven that to be true. This project is better for every "round of friction," every difficulty, and every failed prompt.

I know now that I design best, and am most happy, when I am working with service or program design that look at stakeholders holistically. I also know that I am a better designer for accepting unfamiliar ideas that have challenged my ways of thinking before this course and keep those in my "designer's toolkit," because these seeds of feedback are what will shape the way I approached every project from now on.

Concept Tags

Mark which apply across your body of work. Pulled from the SEMINAL framework plus each week's contributions.

- **SEMINAL Systems (Week 1):** Service · Energy · Material · Interaction/Sensory · Natural · Artificial · Longevity
- **Week 2 (Iconic Beginnings):** Structure Mapping · Far-Field Analogies · Technology Brokering · Experience Economy · Affordances · Anticipation as Design · Controlled Reveal · Sensory Arc · One Resonant Idea
- **Week 3 (Everything Is a World):** Disappearing Interviewer · Curiosity as Structure · Interviewing Users · Invisible Systems Made Visible · Dual Desires · Going Deep
- **Week 4 (The 30-Year Object):** Constraints Increase Variability · Emotionally Durable Design · Craftsmanship · Constraint as Identity · Durability as Desirability · Repair as Understanding
- **Week 5 (Invisible Senses):** Multisensory Design · Frame Innovation · Emotional Design · Obsessive Sensory Attention · Place as Story · Making Invisible Perceptible
- **Week 6 (Curating & Taste):** Curation as Self-Knowledge · System Clustering · Body of Work
- **Week 7 (Get Out of Your Head):** Collective Intelligence · Technology as Teammate · Braintrust · Useful Friction · Candor Without Authority · Service Design Under Pressure
- **Week 8 (Ugly Darlings):** Ugly Darlings · Artful Making · Design with Intent · Iteration at Scale
- **Week 9 (Less But Better):** Reflection-in-Action · Audience as Hero · Obsessive Reduction · The Edit as Design

When You're Ready to Publish

This document gathered your raw material. To make it a *published portfolio*:

1. **Pick a platform.** Webflow, Framer, Notion, Squarespace, or GitHub Pages for a website. Or export this Word doc to PDF. Or, if you want to hand-code, fork the downloadable HTML template.

2. **Curate visuals.** Bring in your hero images, research artifacts, sketches, final design shots. Captions matter as much as images.
3. **Refine the writing.** Read each block out loud. Cut what doesn't earn its space. Lead with the problem, not the deliverable.
4. **Test the 30-second scan.** Show it to someone for 30 seconds. Can they tell what you do, what you care about, and what you've made?